Yale Academic Excellence & Research Fellowship Criteria

Evaluator Guideline 1: Academic Rigor, Intellectual Vitality & Project Feasibility

Section 1: Academic Trajectory & GPA Standards

Reviewers evaluate candidates based on academic seriousness, intellectual curiosity, and rigorous preparation:

1. **Cumulative GPA & Academic Standing**:

• Minimum baseline GPA for consideration: **3.0** / **4.0** (Satisfactory Academic Standing).

• Competitive fellowship threshold: **3.70 - 4.00** indicates highest academic distinction and deep coursework rigor.

• Course selection difficulty, independent study, and capstone research performance are heavily weighted.

2. **Methodological Validity & Feasibility**:

• For research or study projects, the applicant must establish a well-defined question, credible methodology, and achievable timeline (typically 3 to 12 months).

• Background preparation: The student must demonstrate foundational coursework, computational/laboratory techniques, or foreign language competency necessary to carry out the project.

Section 2: Statement of Academic Purpose & Faculty Endorsements

• Evaluators examine the **Academic Statement** for originality, clarity, and genuine scholarly motivation.

• Mandatory Evidence Rule: Academic reviewers MUST cite direct excerpts from the student's statement and supporting faculty recommendation letters.

• Vague generalizations without documentary quotes are disqualified by the automated audit engine.